

INDIA@100 • TECH

# TRILLION DREAMS

AS INDIA DREAMS OF A \$1 TRILLION  
AI ECONOMY, CAN AMBITION AND HOMEGROWN TALENT  
OVERCOME DEEP TECH GAPS AND GLOBAL RIVALS?

BY PALAK AGARWAL

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**ADHAAR. UNIFIED PAYMENTS** Interface. Digital India. Three innovations vaulted India onto the world stage as a digital powerhouse. Yet, in the high-stakes race for foundational artificial intelligence (AI), the technology poised to redefine global economies and geopolitics, India has been mostly on the sidelines.

Slowly, that's starting to change. Propelled by the government's IndiaAI Mission, the country is seeking to build its own AI capabilities. The government has tapped several domestic start-ups in the mission to develop local foundational models, a bold step signaling India is no longer content consuming global technology. It wants to shape what it consumes.

Jaspreet Bindra, founder of AI & Beyond, which trains corporate executives in AI, acknowledges India's growing research and innovation in the field. "India is top 10 in terms of